



A general view of the Rajgir Hockey Stadium. Right: Hockey stick being presented to the Honourable Chief Minister Shri Nitish Kumar.

on the latest skills, techniques, technology, and sports training methodologies.

Lab to Land

Over the past two years, Bihar has made significant strides in sports development, reflected in improved infrastructure, systematic talent identification, and enhanced support for athletes across various disciplines. Central to this transformation has been the active role of the Government of Bihar, which laid the groundwork for a structured and strategic approach to sports development. As the need for more specialised governance became evident, the Bihar State Sports Authority (BSSA) emerged as a fully independent sports governing body, leading the state's sports initiatives. This momentum did not stop there. A dedicated Department of Sports was subsequently established, backed by substantial financial support from the Government of Bihar. This strategic shift has not only expanded the scope of sports administration in the state but also reinforced Bihar's commitment to nurturing sporting talent and achieving excellence at all levels of competition.

Sports as a catalyst for social change

Bihar's focus on sports goes beyond competition — it is a vehicle for social transformation. Sports have the power to unite communities, break down social barriers, and instil values like discipline, teamwork, and perseverance. In a state where socio-economic disparities have long been a challenge, sports are being leveraged as a tool to empower marginalised communities and offer young people

opportunities for upward mobility. Through sports, Bihar is not only aspiring to make its mark on the global stage but is also fostering positive social change within its borders.

The 'Three Pillars' of sports development in Bihar

Bihar's approach to sports development rests on three key pillars: talent identification, talent nurturing, and talent retention, ensuring a holistic strategy to build and sustain athletic success.

Talent Identification: Bihar has implemented a comprehensive scouting system to identify young athletes from both rural and urban areas through initiatives like MASHAAL, Panchayat Sports Clubs, and league matches in sports like kabaddi and volleyball. The National Inter District Junior Athletics Meet (NIDJAM), hosted by Bihar in 2023, has also played a crucial role in district-level talent identification.

Talent Nurturing: To help athletes reach their full potential, the state is developing state-of-the-art training centres and academies, staffed by experienced coaches of national and international repute. Athletes are provided access to advanced training techniques, sports science, and nutrition programmes, along with opportunities to compete in national and international events, gaining critical competitive experience.

Talent Retention: Bihar is committed to offering long-term support to its athletes through programmes such as the "Medal Lao, Naukri Pao" scheme, which provides job placements for medal winners, scholarships, and substantial cash prizes. A supportive ecosystem is

The players of the Indian National Women's Hockey Team strike a happy pose at the stadium before the exhibition match. Right: The Honourable Chief Minister Shri Nitish Kumar unveiling the logo of ACT.

